superteam BRASIL

GUIDE · FULL VERSION

Hackathon submission guide

Everything worth acting on, ordered by how much it moves the outcome.

Section 1 is deterministic.
Everything after it shifts odds and guarantees nothing.

OVERVIEW

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PASS OR FAIL

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1 Hard requirements

These are conditions, not advice.

Read the official rules PDF yourself before submitting. The items below are the ones teams most often get wrong.

FATAL IF MISSED

Every member registers individually before the deadline.

A member who does not is disqualified and can take the whole entry with them. No grace period. Do this first, today, before anything else in this document.

All content in English.

Non-conforming content is express grounds for removal.

Both videos are mandatory.

Pitch 2–3 minutes,
technical demo no more than 3.

Disclose pre-existing work.

Using code or a product you started before the event is explicitly allowed. **Not** disclosing is a disqualifier, with a stated penalty of a future ban and revoked prizes. There is no published penalty for disclosing too much, so over-disclose.

Make the repository public.

A private repo with access granted is admissible, but the published criteria include an explicit open-source question, so a private repo forfeits that point for nothing.

Check the chain requirement for the path you want.

The event itself is open to several ecosystems; the accelerator that follows it is not. The accelerator is worth roughly an order of magnitude more than a prize, so if that is the goal, the chain decision is already made.

If your funding situation is ambiguous, email the organisers.

The eligibility language around outside capital is not precise enough to self-assess.

Prizes are paid to the team leader's wallet.

Agree the split internally first; it is not handled for you.

Sponsor employees, contractors and their household members are excluded.

2 Choose the space before the idea

The highest-leverage decision available.

The space a project sits in dominates everything else. The specific idea inside that space matters far less than teams assume: a conventional idea in a strong space beats a clever one in a weak space, consistently.

This was tested directly on dozens of distinct idea shapes. Not one of them held up once you account for the space it sits in. Idea shapes are, in practice, just labels for which space you chose.

PRACTICAL CONSEQUENCE

If you advise teams, hand them the **space**, not a list of clever concepts. Spaces transfer; ideas do not.

STRONGEST SPACES

- Tokenised treasuries and fixed-income instruments
- Derivatives and perpetuals
- Trading and liquidity infrastructure
- Asset management, vaults, strategy and portfolio products
- Lending, credit and collateral

STRONG

- Real-world-asset origination and tokenisation
- Privacy as a financial feature, not as an end in itself
- Prediction-market infrastructure, settlement and resolution
- Consumer finance with an actual financial mechanism
- Developer and execution infrastructure

WEAK

- Identity and reputation
- Games
- Marketing, loyalty and rewards
- Social and SocialFi

AVOID

These have essentially never cleared the bar.

- Education and learn-to-earn
- Open marketplaces
- Creator monetisation
- Health, fitness and wellness
- General-purpose AI applications and assistants
- NFT ticketing and event tooling

Who to serve

Best to worst

↑ BEST

1. Market makers
2. Institutional investors
3. Liquidity providers
4. Traders
5. Institutions generally
6. AI agents
7. **Developers** MOST CROWDED

   Note "developers" specifically: it is the single most crowded customer choice available and carries no advantage whatsoever. If your stated customer is developers, you are competing with over a thousand projects for no benefit.
8. Creators
9. Students, event organisers, collectors

↓ WORST

The problems that land

Only one family of stated problem reliably separates:

Capital inefficiency | **Front-running** | **Fragmented or fragmenting liquidity**

If your project can honestly be framed as solving one of those, frame it that way.

3 Never ship a mock and describe it as a product

The most common way to lose.

RED-FLAG WORDS

~~MOCKED~~ ~~SIMULATED~~ ~~HARD-CODED~~ ~~PLACEHOLDER~~ ~~STUBBED~~ ~~IN-MEMORY~~ ~~DUMMY DATA~~ ~~NOT YET DEPLOYED~~

Submissions whose own description contains any of these fail at a dramatically higher rate than everything else in this document.

This is not a penalty for hedging. Neutral hedging language carries no penalty at all: it is the mock itself that costs you. Reviewers appear to read “simulated” as “did not build it”.

- ✓ **Cut scope until one path works end to end for real, then submit that path.**
- ✓ **Deploy something, even if it is small and ugly.**
  A deployed narrow thing beats a broad half-stubbed thing.
- ✗ **Never use the word “simulated” anywhere in your description.**
- ✓ **If part of your system is mocked, either finish it, cut it from the submission entirely, or describe the working part and say nothing about the rest.**

WHAT YOU CAN SURVIVE

✓	✓	✗
A dismissive or sceptical summary of your project **does not sink you on its own.**	Being described as incomplete **is survivable.**	Being described as a simulation **is not.**

4 How to write the description

PROJECTS THAT ADVANCE DESCRIBE

What the product does to money

PROJECTS THAT DO NOT DESCRIBE

How it was assembled

That difference is almost entirely register, not substance, and it is the cheapest thing in this document to fix.

USE THIS VOCABULARY

lending · borrowing · positions · deposits · collateral · liquidation · margin · markets · order book · options · yield · liquidity · rebalancing · arbitrage · oracles · settlement · custody · issuance · redemption · protocols · retail · institutional

AVOID THIS VOCABULARY

backend · frontend · built with · dashboard · wallet (as the product) · PDAs

...and the proper names of your hosting, database, UI library and component kit.

Leading with the chain name, or with “built”, is a weak opening.

Structure

1 Open with the financial mechanism.

First sentence states what the product does to money, for whom.

2 Name a specific user segment.

Segment nouns are among the very few things that survive reliably into the record a reviewer actually reads. “Market makers on perp venues” beats “DeFi users”. “Everyone” is worse than nothing.

3 Target roughly 80–100 words for the short description.

Shorter than about 60 and longer than about 120 both do slightly worse. This is a weak effect: do not spend an hour on it, just do not write one line or a full page.



4 One sentence of differentiation.

What you do that the obvious incumbent does not.

5 Technology

What you say, not what you used.

3–5 **Name 3 to 5 technologies. Do not list 8.**

This is the strongest writing-level effect in the entire document: teams that list everything disappear, teams that choose a handful stand out. Listing seven or eight roughly halves you against listing three to five. Descriptions are the same length either way, so this is selection, not brevity.

3–4 **Name 3 to 4 core primitives.**

Naming none is clearly worse. Naming five or six is worse than three or four. Pick the ones that actually carry your design.

✓ **Say the chain name explicitly.**

A large number of projects used a chain and never mentioned it in their description, and they did noticeably worse than projects that said it. Having it in the repository is not enough; saying it is what counts.

✓ **Say “Rust” if you wrote Rust.**

The claim is what carries. Rust present in the repository but never claimed does nothing.

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i **The dominant program framework carries no signal on its own.**

What people attribute to it comes from the language underneath, so name the language.

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i **There is no winning stack.**

No pair of technologies outperforms what each does separately. Stop looking for the combination.

✗ **Never name an LLM vendor.**

Naming any major model provider is among the strongest negative signals measured. Mentioning an LLM at all is negative. AI as a feature inside a financial product is neutral; AI as the product loses.

✗ **Do not name a popular frontend trio together.**

A recognisable frontend stack with nothing underneath it reads as a UI with no product.

✓ **Standards worth naming when true.**

The token standards you actually extend, and any formal spec you implement. Generic infrastructure names add nothing.

6 The team

Explains more about outcomes than anything you write.

Solo	2	3	4	5+
Roughly half as well as teams	Nearly as good	Best of any size	Fine	No further gain
		SWEET SPOT		

Never compete solo.

This is the largest team effect by far. Solo entries do roughly half as well as teams, across every space.

Three is the sweet spot.

Three members performs best of any size with a meaningful sample. Two is nearly as good. Four is fine. The honest version: the step is solo-to-two; between two, three and four the differences are small and you should not reorganise over them. Past four there is no further gain and the samples get thin.

Ship from an organisation account that already existed.

This is the single strongest structural signal available. What it reflects is that you were already a working team before the event, not the account type itself.

Do not create an organisation account now.

Accounts created during the event perform worse than personal accounts once you account for team size. The window for this closed before the event started. Creating one now is cosmetic.

Do not spread across multiple entries.

Teams submitting several projects do worse per entry, and the heaviest multi-submitters typically land none at all. One serious entry beats three hedged ones.

Include a social link for the project or team.

Having one is mildly positive; having none is mildly negative, and it costs nothing.

An extensive public open-source history on the account does not help and is mildly negative.

Do not go curating your profile.

7 Evidence, traction and claims

State one real number you achieved, plainly, in the short description.

One is enough. Users, volume, transactions, revenue, pilots: whatever is true.

Attach it to something inspectable.

A deployed program address, a test suite, a live endpoint, an SDK. Claims anchored to an artefact survive into the record a reviewer reads. Bare commercial figures frequently do not, even for projects that went on to win: several winners had their headline user numbers vanish entirely between what they wrote and what was reviewed.

Do not state market size and call it traction.

A large addressable market says nothing about your product, and a substantial share of what looks like traction in submissions is market-size framing in disguise. Reviewers appear to discount it completely.

Do not rely on your founder story or your "why now" answer reaching anyone.

Those two fields are the most completely lost between what you write and what gets reviewed: personal narrative essentially never survives. If your background is your real advantage, it must appear somewhere structural: the team composition, the organisation account, the repository history. Prose will not carry it.

Named customers, letters of intent and pilots are worth stating, but only if you can name them.

Vague "we are in talks" phrasing does nothing.

Credentials, prior companies and years of experience in prose do nothing measurable.

The structural version of the same claim does.

8 Naming and presentation

Check your name is not taken on the platform before you commit to it.

A duplicate name permanently costs you a rank position in search against whoever registered it first. This takes one lookup.

A short, real dictionary word works well as a name, but pick one from a different field than your product.

A real word that collides with your own domain vocabulary buries you in search behind everything that merely mentions it. Invented compounds work too and avoid the collision entirely.

Avoid digits, odd punctuation and ALL CAPS in the name.

Punctuation survives into your public URL and breaks link previews in chat apps.

Keep the technical demo.

Earlier advice circulating that it was unhelpful was wrong: that pattern was an artefact of teams removing demos after the fact.

WHERE TO SPEND TIME

Name effects are small compared to everything in sections 2 through 7.

Do not spend real time here. Do the duplicate check, then move on.

9 What does not work

Do not spend time on any of these.

Every item here was tested and found to do nothing, or to be actively backwards.

Hitting a word count.	There is no length that performs materially better, no penalty for being short, no penalty for using the full field.
Loading the description with buzzwords.	Domain vocabulary helps; inflated marketing language does not.
Letting a language model write your submission.	Text that reads as machine-written does worse. Write it yourself, plainly.
Naming sponsor technologies hoping for favour.	Naming several is associated with worse outcomes, not better.
Rewriting your description to "match" your category.	Mismatch between how you label yourself and how your project reads carries no penalty at all.
Picking your idea by counting competitors.	Crowd size tells you nothing. Some crowded spaces perform very well; some near-empty ones have never produced anything. Ask whether the **space** has ever done well, not how many people are in it. Acting on crowd count will send you away from good spaces.
Making your repository private.	It does not help and it forfeits an explicit published criterion.
Posting frequent project updates.	There is no reliable evidence this helps.
Counting on a previous win.	Prior success in these events does not carry forward; teams with prior prizes do not advance at a better rate.
Optimising the opening sentence.	No opening formulation outperforms another.
Narrow "target persona" framing for its own sake.	Naming a specific **segment** helps; performing the exercise of writing a persona does not.
Writing a long technical-stack answer.	Longer answers do worse, consistently.
Curating your public code history to look prolific.	Mildly negative.

10 Final checklist

ELIGIBILITY

- [ ] **Every member individually registered** — §1
  The only item here that is fatal alone.
- [ ] All content in English — §1
- [ ] Pitch video 2–3 min; technical demo under 3 min; both present — §1
- [ ] Repository public — §1
- [ ] Pre-existing work disclosed, generously — §1

PRODUCT

- [ ] One path works end to end for real; nothing described as simulated — §3
- [ ] Space chosen from the strongest tiers in section 2 — §2

DESCRIPTION

- [ ] Description opens with the financial mechanism, not the stack — §4
- [ ] A specific user segment named, not “everyone” and not “developers” — §4
- [ ] Roughly 80–100 words in the short description — §4
- [ ] 3 to 5 technologies named, never 8 — §5
- [ ] 3 to 4 core primitives named — §5
- [ ] Chain name stated explicitly — §5
- [ ] “Rust” stated if true — §5
- [ ] No LLM vendor named anywhere — §5
- [ ] One achieved number, attached to something inspectable — §7

NAME AND TEAM

- [ ] Project name checked for duplicates — §8
- [ ] Social link present — §6
- [ ] Team of 2 to 4, ideally 3; not solo — §6
- [ ] One entry, not several — §6

11 How to read this

The strongest factors are structural: who the team is and what space the project is in. Both are decided before the final week.

If you are reading this late, the items you can still act on are concentrated in sections 3, 4, 5 and 7, and the biggest of them by a wide margin is section 3: do not submit a mock described as a product.

3 Never ship a mock
4 The description
5 Technology
7 Evidence and claims

There is a controllable part of this and a part that is noise. Getting into the credible band is worth a great deal. Beyond that band, projects that advance and projects that do not become genuinely hard to tell apart, and no amount of further editing changes that.

Once your submission is clear, accurate and complete, stop.

Spend the remaining time on the product.